

The Peptide Guide We Wish We'd Had

What we wish we knew before we started researching peptides.

WHAT YOU'LL FIND

What peptides are. How the legal side actually works. What's being studied.

What to sort out before you spend a dollar.

WHAT YOU WON'T

Doses. A plan. Anyone's numbers presented as your answer. Your stack gets built on your history, your labs, your goals.



01

OPTIMIZATION



02

MIND



03

FUEL



04

MOVEMENT

Educational purposes only. We do not diagnose, treat, or prescribe. All compounds discussed are intended for research use only and are not for human consumption.

What a peptide actually is

A short chain of amino acids. Amino acids are the building blocks of protein, and a peptide is what you get when a small number of them link together in a specific order. Your body already makes thousands of them. Insulin is a peptide. So is oxytocin. So is ghrelin, the one that makes you hungry.



01

A message

Peptides are messengers. They carry a signal your body already recognizes, telling tissue to repair itself or telling the pituitary to release growth hormone.



02

Not an ingredient

A supplement supplies a raw material. A hormone replaces something directly. A peptide is neither. It is a message, not an ingredient.



03

Sequence is everything

Change one amino acid and it is a different compound entirely, with different research behind it. Two names that look similar are not interchangeable.

WHY MIDLIFE

Peptide production declines with age. Growth hormone signaling is the clearest example, and it is much of why this gets attention in midlife at all.

The four stacks

Peptides sit in one of these four, and only one. Everything else in this guide makes more sense once you know which stack you are actually working on.



01

Optimization

Peptides, supplements, medications, labs, and the tools you track with. This is the amplifier, and it is the smallest of the four.

WHERE PEPTIDES LIVE



02

Mind

Sleep, stress load, and how you manage both. A dysregulated system does not respond well to anything, and that includes peptides.

THE ONE PEOPLE SKIP



03

Fuel

How you eat most of the time. Protein, hydration, and consistency, not the perfect week you had once in March.

FOUNDATION



04

Movement

How you move, how often, and how you recover from it. Type matters less than showing up on the days you scheduled.

FOUNDATION

The work is not optional. Movement, Fuel, and Mind are the foundation. Peptides amplify what is already there.

What is being studied

Nicknames below are what these are called in the community. They are not claims. Nothing here is a protocol or a recommendation.

FDA STATUS KEY

APPROVED

IN TRIALS

RESEARCH ONLY

Fat loss & metabolism THE GLP-1 FAMILY

Semaglutide APPROVED

Studied for appetite regulation, glycemic control, and weight loss.

Tirzepatide APPROVED

Studied for appetite regulation, glycemic control, and body composition. Acts on two receptor pathways.

Retatrutide IN TRIALS

Studied for appetite regulation and metabolic rate. Acts on three receptor pathways.

Growth hormone support SLEEP, MUSCLE, RECOVERY

Sermorelin

THE SLEEP AND SKIN PEPTIDE

Studied for growth hormone signaling, body composition, skin, and sleep.

CJC-1295

THE AMPLIFIER

Studied for sustained growth hormone signaling, recovery, and sleep. Typically paired with Ipamorelin.

Ipamorelin

THE RECOVERY PEPTIDE

Studied for pulsed growth hormone release, sleep quality, and lean mass.

Tesamorelin

THE BELLY FAT PEPTIDE

Studied for visceral fat, with emerging research on cognition in older adults.

Repair & recovery HEALING AND RESILIENCE

BPC-157

BODY PROTECTION COMPOUND

Studied in preclinical models for soft tissue and tendon repair, gut lining integrity, and systemic inflammation.

TB-500

THE FLEXIBILITY PEPTIDE

Studied for cell migration, connective tissue recovery, range of motion, and scar tissue.

KPV

THE CALM THE GUT PEPTIDE

Studied for inflammation in the digestive tract, including bloating and IBS-type discomfort.

GHK-Cu

KNOWN IN THE COMMUNITY AS THE GLOW-UP PEPTIDE

A copper peptide studied for collagen production, skin firmness, fine lines, and hair. One of the better-studied compounds in this guide.

Cellular energy & longevity

ENERGY, FOCUS, LONGEVITY

NAD+

THE ENERGY COENZYME

Not a peptide but a coenzyme, used by cells in energy production and DNA repair. Levels decline with age. Studied for mental clarity, energy, and mitochondrial function.

MOTS-c

THE EXERCISE MIMIC

Studied for metabolic regulation, insulin sensitivity, and mitochondrial function. Research often frames it as mimicking some effects of exercise at the cellular level.

Epitalon

THE LONGEVITY PEPTIDE

Studied for cellular aging markers, sleep, and antioxidant response.

Mood & focus

CALM, CLARITY, MEMORY

Selank

THE CALM PEPTIDE

Studied for anxiety response without sedation, and for sleep quality.

Semax

THE FOCUS PEPTIDE

Studied for focus, memory, and cognitive clarity.

Thymosin Alpha-1

THE IMMUNE PEPTIDE

Studied for immune modulation and inflammatory response. Approved in some countries, not the US.

Sexual health

LIBIDO AND DESIRE

PT-141

KNOWN IN THE COMMUNITY AS THE LIBIDO PEPTIDE

Studied for desire and arousal in both men and women. Acts through the brain rather than the vascular system.

Every compound in this directory is intended for research use only and is not for human consumption. None are approved by the FDA for the uses described unless the badge says otherwise.

Why people stack

Vendors sell pre-mixed vials, usually under names that are not official and appear on no label. The appeal is real: fewer injections, one timeline to track, and compounds whose research areas overlap. A single blended vial can cover tissue repair, skin, sleep, and fat loss at the same time.

You will see four names constantly. Knowing what is inside them is the point of this page.

NAME	CONTAINS
Glow	BPC-157 + TB-500 + GHK-Cu
Fit Stack	CJC-1295 + Ipamorelin
Wolverine	BPC-157 + TB-500
KLOW	KPV + BPC-157 + TB-500 + GHK-Cu

READ THIS BEFORE YOU BLEND

If you react to a blend, you will not know which component caused it.

A four-peptide vial is four variables introduced on the same day. If something goes wrong, your only option is to stop all of it and start over one at a time, which costs you the vial and the weeks you already spent. Single compounds are slower and they are the only way to learn what your body does with each one.

Reconstitution

Peptides ship as a dry powder. Adding bacteriostatic water brings them back into solution. Insulin syringes are marked in units, not millilitres, so the only number that matters is how much compound sits in one unit. That is decided the moment you choose your water volume.

VIAL SIZE	BAC WATER	CONCENTRATION
5 mg	1 mL	5,000 mcg / mL
5 mg	2 mL	2,500 mcg / mL
10 mg	2 mL	5,000 mcg / mL

Same vial, different water, completely different result. Their 10 units is not your 10 units.

Startup checklist

[GET IT IN THE TOOLKIT](#)

☐ BACTERIOSTATIC WATER
Preserved. Not sterile water, not saline.

☐ INSULIN SYRINGES
Marked in units.

☐ ALCOHOL SWABS
Stopper and site. Every single time.

☐ SHARPS CONTAINER
Never a household bin.

☐ REFRIGERATED STORAGE
For anything reconstituted.

☐ BASELINE LABS
Before day one.

☐ VETTED SOURCING
Third-party tested, certificates you can read.

☐ A WAY TO TRACK IT
See page 09.

What we learned the hard way

None of this is about what to take. It is the part nobody mentions until you have already made the mistake.

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- 01 **Do not over-order.** Tempting when there is a discount. But you do not know yet how you will respond to any of it, and a reaction means you are sitting on product you cannot use.
-
- 02 **Bacteriostatic water has its own clock.** Once punctured, typically good for about 28 days. Check the label. That is a separate timeline from your vial's.
-
- 03 **Reconstitute one vial at a time.** Powder is stable. In solution it is on a countdown. Several at once means several clocks, and one busy stretch will cost you product.
-
- 04 **Log site reactions separately.** Local and systemic are different signals. Recording them on one line makes patterns much harder to see later.
-
- 05 **Start when you can pay attention.** The first few doses are when you learn the most, and only if you are actually watching.
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- 06 **Photograph the vial and the batch number.** Before the box goes in the trash. For certificate lookups, for problems, and for reordering the exact same thing.
-

A stack you stopped is not a failure. It is data. Nothing here is meant to stay the same forever.

Track it or it did not happen

We tried a spreadsheet. We tried the notes app. We missed start dates and lost track of changes. Print this page, or use something built for it.

DATE	COMPOUND	DOSE	SITE	NOTES

Also worth recording, off this grid: what you stopped, why you stopped it, and how long it took to get back to baseline. That is the entry people skip and want back later.



WHAT WE USE INSTEAD

Regimen

It handles the vial math, which is the part that broke every other system we tried.

CODE STACKED



Download on the
App Store



GET IT ON
Google Play

Join The Stacked Couple Community on Circle

The Stacked Couple Community is **FREE**. Your membership starts in The Lab.

This is where the real conversation happens. The stuff we cannot post on social: compound names, the basics, vendor recommendations, and the foundation you need to start building your own stack.

[JOIN FOR FREE →](#)[HOSTED ON CIRCLE](#)

OUR SOURCE



Ascension Peptides

Third-party testing through MZ Biolabs, with a published certificate library. Code STACKED for 50% off.

[SHOP ASCENSION](#)

RESEARCH USE ONLY

All compounds discussed in this guide are intended for laboratory research use only and are not for human consumption. That labeling is what allows their sale without FDA drug approval. It is not a formality. In practice it means no prescription, no clinician reviewing your case, no guarantee of pharmaceutical manufacturing standards, and no recall system. Purity and accuracy depend entirely on the vendor. All compounds sold by Ascension Peptides are for research purposes only. The Stacked Couple is not responsible for how these compounds are used.

MEDICAL DISCLAIMER

This guide is for educational and informational purposes only. We are not clinicians. We do not diagnose, treat, or prescribe. Nothing here is medical advice or intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any condition. Most compounds named are not approved by the FDA for the uses described. The regulatory picture changes constantly, so check current status before you act. Speak with a qualified healthcare provider and get baseline labs before starting, changing, or stopping anything.